UI / UX DESIGN REVIEW REPORT • V2

A Comparative Teardown of Five Leading Mobile Applications

Spotify • Duolingo • Google Maps • Swiggy • Notion



Spotify



Duolingo



Google Maps



Swiggy



Notion

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INTRODUCTION

Objective & Review Methodology

This report evaluates the interface and experience design of five widely used apps across media, education, navigation, food delivery and productivity — to surface transferable UI/UX patterns and improvement opportunities.

Apps Under Review

- **Spotify** Music & Podcast Streaming
- **Duolingo** Language Learning
- **Google Maps** Maps & Local Search
- **Swiggy** Restaurants & Grocery
- **Notion** Notes & Workspace

Navigation & IA
Feature discovery, tab structure, wayfinding

Visual Design
Colour, typography, layout hierarchy, consistency

Interaction & Onboarding
First-run experience, gestures, friction

Personalization
Recommendations, adaptive content, user control

Accessibility & Trust
Contrast, readability, security cues

Spotify

Media — Music & Podcast Streaming

8.9
/10 UX SCORE

Design goal: put the right track one tap away, whatever the mood.

UI Dark, content-first UI with bold album art and a persistent mini-player.

UX Personalised home, Daily Mixes and seamless queue control.

UI / UX Strengths

- Persistent mini-player keeps playback controls reachable on every screen
- Album-art-led cards make browsing visual and fast to scan
- Shelves like Made For You turn a huge catalogue into a short list
- Gesture support (swipe to queue, long-press for options) feels native

Friction Points & Opportunities

- Free-tier ads and shuffle limits interrupt the listening flow
- Library, search and Premium upsells compete in a crowded bottom bar
- Deep settings and audio-quality controls are hard to find

Duolingo

Education — Language Learning

8.8
/10 UX SCORE

Design goal: make daily practice feel like a game you do not want to break.

UI Playful illustrations, rounded buttons and a clear learning path.

UX Short lessons, instant feedback and streaks that build habit.

UI / UX Strengths

- Single winding path shows exactly what to do next
- Instant colour and sound feedback on every answer
- Streaks, XP and leagues drive daily retention
- Onboarding sets a goal and level in under a minute

Friction Points & Opportunities

- Hearts and ads limit practice at moments of high motivation
- Gamification can overshadow real learning progress
- Grammar explanations are tucked away behind small tips

Google Maps

Navigation — Maps & Local Search

8.5
/10 UX SCORE

Design goal: get anyone from A to B with minimum thought and maximum trust.

UI Map-first layout with a floating search bar and bottom sheet.

UX Live traffic, rerouting and rich place details in one place.

UI / UX Strengths

- Bottom sheet reveals detail progressively without hiding the map
- Turn-by-turn view uses large type and strong contrast
- Colour-coded routes make traffic delays obvious at a glance
- Saved places and Explore tabs reduce repeated typing

Friction Points & Opportunities

- Layers, filters and pins crowd the map in dense cities
- Newer features (reviews, photos, ads) add clutter to place cards
- Offline maps and sharing options are not obvious

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Swiggy

Food Delivery — Restaurants & Grocery

7.8
/10 UX SCORE

Design goal: move from craving to checkout in as few taps as possible.

UI Orange brand colour, food photography and card-based restaurant lists.

UX Smart search, reorder and live order tracking.

UI / UX Strengths

- Food photos and ratings help quick decisions
- Live tracking map reduces order anxiety
- One-tap reorder and saved addresses speed up repeat orders
- Offers are shown on cards at the point of choice

Friction Points & Opportunities

- Home screen carries banners, carousels and offers all at once
- Fees and totals appear late, only at checkout
- Switching between food and Instamart feels like two apps

Notion

Productivity — Notes & Workspace

7.3
/10 UX SCORE

Design goal: give people one flexible space for notes, tasks and docs.

UI Minimal, monochrome canvas with a collapsible sidebar.

UX Blocks, templates and databases adapt to many workflows.

UI / UX Strengths

- Block-based editing is consistent across pages
- Slash commands let users add content without menus
- Templates give new users a working starting point
- Sidebar hierarchy mirrors how people organise ideas

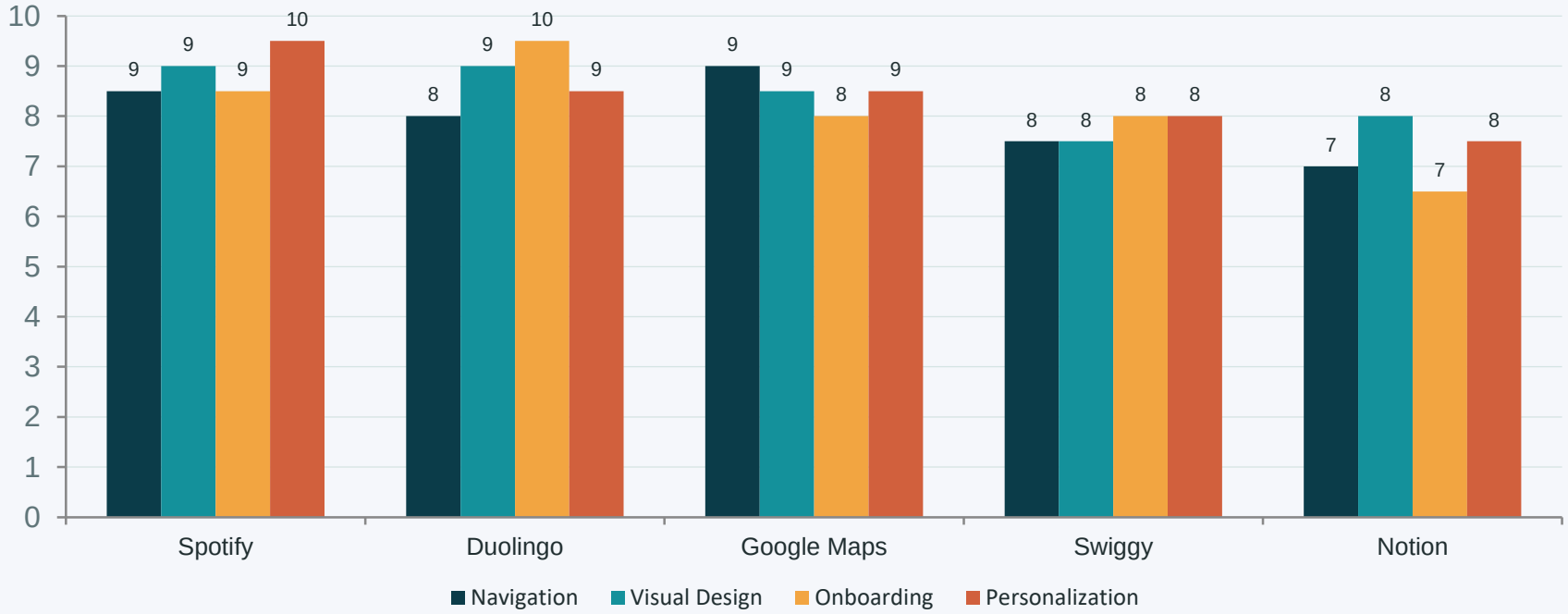
Friction Points & Opportunities

- Mobile editing is slower and more limited than desktop
- Blank-page start overwhelms first-time users
- Databases and relations have a steep learning curve

COMPARATIVE ANALYSIS

UX Heuristic Scores Across Apps

Scored 1–10 on Nielsen-informed heuristics: Navigation, Visual Design, Onboarding and Personalization.



KEY FINDINGS

Cross-App UI/UX Patterns Observed

1 Content-First Design

Spotify, Swiggy and Google Maps lead with imagery or maps, so the main content does the talking.

2 Progressive Disclosure

Google Maps and Notion reveal detail only when needed, keeping first views calm.

3 Gamification Drives Habit

Duolingo streaks and Spotify Wrapped-style recaps turn one-off use into routine.

4 Personalization Builds Loyalty

Spotify mixes and Swiggy reorders cut effort by learning from past behaviour.

5 Persistent Anchors

Mini-players, floating search and tab bars keep users oriented at all times.

6 Monetization Is the Weak Link

Ads, hearts and upsells appear at high-friction moments across Spotify, Duolingo and Swiggy.

DESIGN RECOMMENDATIONS

What Every Team Should Take Away

1

Time monetization to natural breakpoints
Show ads and upsells after a song, lesson or order — never in the middle of one.

2

Keep dense screens scannable
Limit competing banners and layers, as seen on Swiggy and Google Maps.

3

Make advanced features discoverable
Add tooltips and templates so Notion-style power tools do not overwhelm beginners.

4

Show costs and limits early
Surface fees (Swiggy) and hearts or ad limits (Duolingo) before the user commits.

CONCLUSION

Great UX Is Built Around One Job

The strongest apps design the interface around the single job the user came to do, then hide everything else until it is needed.

S	D	G	S	N
Spotify	Duolingo	Google Maps	Swiggy	Notion
8.9	8.8	8.5	7.8	7.3
UX SCORE	UX SCORE	UX SCORE	UX SCORE	UX SCORE

Ranking reflects this review's average across navigation, visual design, onboarding and personalization.